

LG My PC

Not My PC, is it yours?

The LG PC promotes the thin-and-mean look, with all its components cramped into a sleek grey cabinet that can be mounted horizontally or vertically on the provided stand. A decent LG 700s 17-inch monitor is also included.

The PC had a Pentium4 1.9 GHz coupled to a Biostar motherboard, based on an 845GL chipset with just 128 MB DDR RAM. Upgrading is a big challenge since there's hardly any space for expansion. Also, the motherboard has no option to upgrade to a graphics card, since it lacks an AGP slot. Fortunately, a LAN controller and six-channel sound are integrated; a 56K PCI modem is also provided. The multimedia keyboard provides good tactile feedback, but the mouse makes for sore wrists. Turbo Linux is pre-installed and other than the Windows drivers CD, no additional software is provided.

Due to the processor's lower clock speed, performance was decent in the processor-intensive tests, but it was surpassed by all other PCs, the only exception being the PCS value PC. Gaming performance was poor, due to the lack of a graphics card, but it was better than the Compaq systems. It failed to complete the Zdbench Content test as it has only 128 MB RAM. It also took a long time to complete the processor-intensive tests.

It's definitely expensive, considering that it has low-end hardware specifications and just bundles Turbo Linux. Instead, look out for options that offer better configuration and better performance at the same price.

Price: Rs 32,800
+ Plenty of bundled software
- A tad expensive



LG My PC	B-
Performance	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Features	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Build quality	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Value for money	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮

PCS Oriion Silver Magic Multimedia PC

Jazzy PC

The PCS Multimedia PC had the least number of features of all the PCs we tested. The roomy cabinet sports a jazzy metallic finish that was again highlighted by the silver finished monitor and peripherals.

It comes with a Pentium 4 2.4 GHz mounted on a Kobian motherboard based on the Intel 845 chipset with 128 MB DDR RAM. The onboard Intel graphics controller handles the video capability. In terms of upgrade options, the motherboard has just two PCI slots, and two memory slots. An AGP slot was not provided. The multimedia keyboard and a dated mouse. Further, the 15-inch monitor does not justify it being called a performance PC. It was pre-loaded with Windows XP Home edition and came with no other software.

The processor sub-system was all fired up because of the presence of the Pentium 2.4 GHz—the processor performance was on par with the Dart PCs, with this system losing by a very small margin. The audio-encoding test results were commendable. The hard disk performance was quite low, and this will reflect in day-to-day tasks. This also caused it to log very low scores in the PSbench test.

At Rs 34,700, the multimedia PC is slightly overpriced. Overall, a better hard disk and a 17-inch monitor would justify the price.

Price: Rs 34,700
+ Windows XP OS provided
- Too less features



PCS Oriion Silver Magic Multimedia PC	B-
Performance	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Features	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Build quality	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Value for money	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮

Branded Vs Assembled		
Parameters	Branded PC	Assembled PC
Configuration	Since branded PC are pre-configured in terms of hardware components, you have little choice when it comes to customising them.	Assembled PCs offer the advantage of configuring the hardware components to your need and liking.
Authenticity of components	Rarely do you end up with a fake component in a branded PC, since they are directly sourced from the manufacturers.	Ensure that you get original components for an assembled PC by buying them from an authorised dealer.
Quality control	Branded PCs usually go through stringent quality-control processes, with each component being tested for reliability and fault tolerance to ensure trouble-free operation.	Assembled PCs are rarely confined to any sort of quality-control process, and hence the chances of trouble setting in at early stages are high.
Support	Branded PCs have an excellent after-sales support system in place that's always a phone call away. Major PC brands in India have support round the clock in all major cities, besides providing various levels of support such as e-mail, etc.	The after-sales support for assembled PCs depends on your assembler's network and reach. However, the service provided by them is nowhere near that provided by branded players.
Availability	Availability can be a problem with branded PCs, since they have limited reach, especially in smaller cities. This scenario is changing quite fast.	Availability is never a question since you'll find a system assembler round every corner today.
Price	You not only pay for the system price, but also for other support services, genuine software and taxes. Hence, they usually cost more than assembled PCs with the same configuration.	Assembled PCs cost lesser than their branded counterparts for the same configurations, since they just come with assurances, and at times, pirated software.
Package Experience	The package experience, or in other terms, the satisfaction derived is always on the higher side for a branded PC.	Similarly, a good assembled PC can provide the same level of satisfaction as the branded PC, but that happens rarely.